



If you want to participate in a community open source project, LibriVox is the perfect place to start. Just pick an open source book title, read it out, record the reading, and upload. This lets you create audiobooks that hundreds of users will listen to

FREE MEDIA

Technology is now empowering artists to create and distribute content for free or for social causes. We profile people who are part of this trend

Aditya Madanapalle
aditya.madanapalle@thinkdigit.com

At the turn of the century, tools for creating, publishing and distributing multimedia were easily available to anyone who wanted to express themselves in video or audio form. Production studios could be built inside homes, with equipment that was no longer as expen-



Adil, Sanket K, Sanket J and Hardik form The False Positives

sive as it once was. This allowed individuals and small groups to self-produce music, video, and other forms of content, then share it over the web. Aspects of the Free and Open Source (FOSS) movement was adapted in the form of the Creative Commons license, that allowed content creators to selectively license the works that they were putting on line. Alternative and independent sources of entertainment quickly became mainstream, with sites such as Google Video, Vimeo, Jamendo and MySpace. It took a good decade, but in 2009 artists who started with a MySpace profile page and a few downloads eventually ended up featuring prominently on international charts. This trend is known as a "MySpace sensation" in the west, and it is something that we are only beginning to see in India. Indian rock bands regularly post their songs on sites such as Soundclick

and RSJonline. YouTube is the host of choice for short films. We have a look at some producers of alternative media.

The False Positives

The False Positives are a new Mumbai based rock band that has come together for creating one album with a purpose. The album, called Redeemer, is full of songs that affect children, and encourages the listeners to donate to CRY, as the album is free. This album is exclusively on our Playware DVD. The band is made up of Adil Mansure on the rhythm guitars, vocals and keyboard, Sanket Khadilkar on the lead guitar and backing vocals, Sanket Jariwala on the Drums and vocals and the voice of Hardik Varma for one track. The band follows the musical sensibilities of bands such as Guns N'

Roses, Alterbridge and Tool. These are all Mumbai-based people who have dayjobs, who decided to express their musical instincts by creating an album, and petition for a social cause at the same time. In the words of Sanket Jariwala, "These songs are typically about the things that haunt little children the most in this day and age. lovelessness, marital discord and war. These songs were written over some years and are a true testament of how we, as a band, feel about issues that impact children, who are perhaps even

unable to understand their own situation. We played these songs live, and recorded them live to ensure the rawness of how we feel, reaches you intact. But this is not as much about the music, as it is about us, the "grown ups" pledging some support, consistently, to causes that can help underprivileged children live a better, fuller life. The children count on your support. We hope you like the music"

Mam Movies

A production house built around the idea of "media for social change", Mam Movies is run by Madhusudan and Meghna Aggarwal, based in Ahmedabad. Over the past few years, Mam movies has been actively involved in community based film projects. These projects not only encourage established and aspiring short film makers to generate films, but also help social causes and active NGOs in the progress. The Genesis film project, brought together 101 film makers to make 101 films, documenting the efforts of 101 NGOs. In the process, the NGOs got a chance to voice their activities in video form. The She Creates project was an effort that highlighted the plight of the

girl child, in a very unique way. Groups of schoolgirls were picked up from different schools in Mumbai, and coached by leaders in the industry on the various aspects of film making. Advanced topics such as narrative structure of a short film, photography techniques, and editing were all taught

Send us your content!

Have you recorded a music album or even a few tracks? Have you made a short film and are excited about sharing it with people? Do you dabble in machinima or make 3D demos? If you have original content, of any kind, that you would like to share, just write in to DVD@thinkdigit.com, and we will carry it on our DVDs for all our readers.



Madhusudan and Meghna encouraging smiles